



Strategic Plan [2026-2030]

[A plan towards Consolidation of Programme Impact,
and Organisational Sustainability ...]



LIFE HELPERS INITIATIVE

**GOSHEN DEVELOPMENT CENTER,
TAMAJE, SOKOTO**

30th April 2026

LHI Strategic Plan [2026-2030]



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Life Helpers Initiative Strategic Plan, 2026-2030

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0.1 Acronyms and Abbreviations

BCC	- Behaviour Change Communication
BoT	- Board of Trustees
CBOs	- Community-Based Organisations
CSOs	- Civil Society Organisations
ED	- Executive Director
FCT	- Federal Capital Territory
GDP	- Gross Domestic Product
HR/HR	- Human Rights / Human Resource
ICT	- Information Communication Technology
KSS	- Knowledge Sharing Session
LHI	- Life Helpers Initiative
M&E	- Monitoring and Evaluation
MDAs	- Ministries, Departments, and Agencies
MERL	- Monitoring, Evaluation, Research & Learning
NGOs	- Non-Governmental Organisations
PHC	- Primary Healthcare Centre
SDGs	- Sustainable Development Goals
SGBV	- Sexual and Gender-based Violence
SWOT	- Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities, and Threats
WASH	- Water, Sanitation, and Hygiene
WHO	- World Health Organisation



Foreword

The Life Helpers Initiative Strategic Plan 2026–2030 marks a pivotal stage in our organisation’s development. Founded on the principle that everyone deserves dignity, hope, and purpose, LHI remains dedicated to enhancing the well-being and resilience of vulnerable populations through integrated development and humanitarian efforts.

From our beginnings as the Beulah Project to our evolution into a multi-state organisation, our story has been one of growth, courage, and transformation. Today, LHI operates across regions marked by insecurity, poverty, and limited access to essential services, yet these same regions are also home to extraordinary resilience and untapped potentials. As the document notes, “LHI has grown into a multi-state development and humanitarian organisation... addressing the root causes of vulnerability and poverty.”

The last strategic period demonstrated what is possible when dedication meets opportunity. We secured over eight billion naira in grants, strengthened our internal systems, expanded infrastructure, and invested in the capacity of our staff. We built partnerships, amplified community voices, and delivered interventions that touched lives in profound ways. These achievements are a testament to the collective effort of our staff, volunteers, partners, and the communities who trust us.

But we also confronted realities that tested our resolve, insecurity, inconsistent funding, socio-cultural barriers, climate shocks, and systemic gaps. These challenges did not deter us; they sharpened our focus and strengthened our determination. They shaped this new strategic direction, one that is bold, adaptive, and deeply rooted in evidence, collaboration, and compassion.

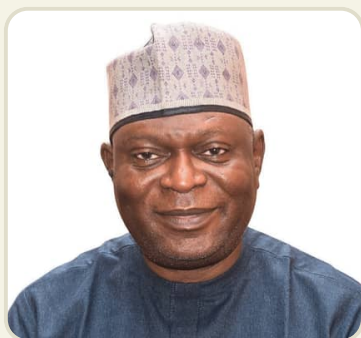
This Strategic Plan is more than a document, it is a promise:

- A promise to deepen our impact across our six thematic areas.
- A promise to strengthen systems, amplify advocacy, and elevate community leadership.
- A promise to uphold our core values of Love, Honesty, and Inclusion in every action we take.
- A promise to pursue our vision of “a more fulfilled life for everyone.”

As we move forward, I thank the Board members, the Executive Director, the Senior Leadership Team, the entire staff, volunteers, partners, and communities for their dedication to our mission. Together, we will build hope, strengthen systems, and transform lives.

Together, we will create a future where every person — regardless of background — can thrive.

Engr. Godfrey Mayuku
Chairman, LHI Board of Trustees



Acknowledgments

It was simply just a passion – a passion to touch lives, a passion to make children feel wanted, an attempt to restore their dignity, which, for different reasons, has been stolen from them. And the journey started. That passion now has a structure, a vehicle, and over the years, it has become stronger and better.

Our progress is the result of many contributions, inspirations, and sacrifices. I want to recognise and appreciate our dynamic Board of Trustees—both incorporated and co-opted members—who have tirelessly offered support, guidance, advice, oversight, and resources for more than 20 years. Their dedication and critical input have shaped our direction and ensured our success.

I would like to acknowledge and appreciate the Senior Leadership Team and the National Management Team members for their unwavering support and commitment to developing this plan and to the vision at large. Your roles have been vital. To the entire staff who participated in the key informant interviews I conducted, and those who contributed to the development of this plan during the workshop or at the various points of review, you have all done awesomely well.

Much kudos goes to our partners, who over time have unreservedly supported and inspired us on this journey. These international Non-governmental organisation partners, such as the International Rescue Committee, Save the Children International, World Food Programme, Care International, Plan International Nigeria, UNICEF, ZOA, among others, with donor partners like FCDO, UN, EU/ECHO, and USG/OHA, GAC, that have consistently demonstrated their commitment to localization, sharing capacities, and providing hands-on technical and financial support. Life Helpers is indebted to their graceful support, not only to the development of this plan, but to the overall development of the organisation. And to Kustos Management Services for their professionalism, expertise, and technical insights and efforts in making this document.

In conclusion, Life Helpers is evolving to meet the demands of the humanitarian, development, and peace nexus by enhancing internal processes, investing in personnel, and establishing a strategic vision for the future. The organisation is adopting new operational approaches with an increased focus on clients and beneficiaries to support their growth and well-being. And by strengthening partnerships and relationships, Life Helpers aims to maximize its impact. With this newly developed Strategic Plan, the organisation is positioning itself to achieve greater outcomes in alignment with its mission and name.

We are Life Helpers.

Tayo Fatinikun.
Executive Director,

30th April 2026



1.0

Introduction & Background



1.1 Life Helpers Initiative [LHI]

The Life Helpers Initiative (LHI) is a Nigerian non-governmental organisation committed to improving the well-being, resilience, and dignity of vulnerable populations through integrated development and humanitarian interventions. LHI aims to provide an enabling environment for marginalized people in various aspects of their lives by improving their knowledge, ability, and skills; increasing their access to service delivery systems, leveraging existing structures, building partnerships and collaboration; strengthening the capacity of individual households, and improving networking and linkages with service providers and partners. Through different partnerships, memoranda of understanding, and grants, LHI has delivered key interventions across a spectrum of sectors, cutting across humanitarian, development, resilience, and disaster management. The main focus areas are health, education, food security, livelihoods, social inclusion, and protection. LHI has its headquarters at Sokoto, and has carried out interventions in States including Adamawa, Bauchi, Gombe, Borno, Ebonyi, Katsina, Kebbi, Plateau, Yobe, and Zamfara States, and a Liaison office in the FCT.

Life Helpers, originally known as the Beulah Project, is a grassroots initiative focused on responding to immediate community needs through assistance and targeted social support. Over time, the initiative expanded its scope and institutional capacity, transitioning from a localised project into a structured organisation with broader development ambitions. This transition led to the establishment of the Life Helpers Initiative, which adopted a more formal organisational structure and strategic orientation. Since its formation, LHI has grown into a multi-state development and humanitarian organisation, implementing programmes across several sectors that address the root causes of vulnerability and poverty.

LHI mainly works in the northern part of Nigeria, a region that faces significant developmental challenges related to insecurity, poverty, and limited access to essential services. Several of these states, particularly Borno, Yobe, and Adamawa in the northeast, have been heavily affected by prolonged conflict and displacement associated with insurgency and insecurity.

LHI is a leading Nigerian, Non-governmental organisation working in development and humanitarian sectors, using community-led approaches to empower marginalized people.

In these areas, LHI works with communities to strengthen service delivery systems, support livelihood recovery, and improve access to education and health services. Programmes often focus on restoring livelihood and building resilience among populations affected by displacement and economic disruption.

Other states, such as Plateau, Bauchi, Sokoto, Kebbi, Zamfara, and Katsina, face a combination of developmental challenges, including high poverty rates, limited infrastructure, and climate-related risks affecting agriculture and livelihoods.

The organisation also operates in Ebonyi State in the southeastern region and the Federal Capital Territory (FCT), where programmes focus on strengthening health, social protection, livelihood opportunities, and inclusive community development.

This geographic diversity requires LHI to adopt flexible programming strategies that respond to the specific needs and vulnerabilities of each region while maintaining consistent institutional standards across all programme areas.



1.2

Key Achievements in the Recent Past (Institutional)

- LHI secured grant portfolios of over ₦8 billion between 2021 and 2025 to implement projects across several states.
- Through effective community engagement, LHI established and maintained good relationships with key stakeholders at the state level, local government, and community levels, including security officers who helped to ensure that LHI's work is safe in rural communities.
- Strengthened its internal systems by putting in place relevant and appropriate policies and systems that are relevant to its growth and development. This included migrating the accounting software from QuickBooks to Enterprise Resource Planning (ERP), which enhanced the financial system, and using Kobo Collect (a tool for virtual data collection), as well as strengthening the Monitoring, Evaluation, and Learning system.
- Improved Staff technical capacities (knowledge, attitude, and skills) through multiple channels, such as internal training via Knowledge Sharing Sessions (KSS), programs sponsored by the organisation, and support from partners' training initiatives.
- Invested in critical infrastructure, including office buildings, secured spacious office facilities, procured office fittings, equipment, and procured working tools that enabled staff to work seamlessly and effectively.
- Partnerships and Bonding with ex-staff. Staff who have left the organisation and who made an exceptional contribution to the organisation are included in the LHI "Hall of Fame". LHI created a WhatsApp page to maintain communication with ex-staff. Through this networking mechanism, LHI receives information about funding and partnership opportunities, which have led to positive outcomes in the past.
- Created a dynamic Communications Unit, equipped with the necessary tools to produce videos, documentaries, and radio talk shows that connect communities, government, and stakeholders on governance, inclusion, and development issues.



Key Achievements in the Recent Past (Programmatic)



The key achievements highlighted above pertain solely to institutional capacity. They do not reflect the significant impact achieved through various programs that improved lives, transformed households, and positively affected numerous communities where LHI operated. These life-changing achievements can be found in multiple compilations of human-interest stories on the organisation's website and social media platforms.

Challenges encountered in the implementation of the Strategic Plan 2022 – 2025



Some key challenges encountered during the implementation of the expired strategic plan in the different sectors include, but are not limited to:

- ✦ Inconsistent funding flows
- ✦ Staff attrition
- ✦ Insecurity
- ✦ Limited unrestricted funds
- ✦ Stockout of health commodities,
- ✦ Inability to access the DHIS.
- ✦ Limited infrastructure and other needed basic resources
- ✦ Political interference,
- ✦ Limited project timelines,
- ✦ Economic instability, Inflation, cost of living, and limited or restricted resources.
- ✦ Deeply rooted socio-cultural norms and religious bias,
- ✦ Weak institutions to help protect the rights of abused persons,
- ✦ Misconceptions about the programme.
- ✦ Negative effects of climate change, particularly flooding.

This new strategic plan acknowledges these challenges and has included measures in the operational plan to address them.



1.3 The LHI 2026-2030 Strategic Plan Development Process

This is the third strategic plan developed by LHI. The process that birthed the plan consists of the following stages:

- ✦ Desk review of relevant documents.
- ✦ Development of templates to gather information
- ✦ The strategy review and planning workshop, which was conducted at LHI's Office, Goshen Development Centre, Tamaje, Eastern Bye-pass Road, Sokoto, from February 23 to 27, 2026. The event included virtual participation by some Board members, while the Executive Director, Senior Leadership Team, National Management Team, and other key staff attended in person, with some individuals participating both virtually and physically.

Pictorial Evidence of the Strategic Plan Development Process for LHI 2026-2030



The strategy review and planning process used comprised three key phases:

01

A step back in time

to review the key achievements, key success factors, and major challenges surmounted, to serve as lessons learnt from implementing the previous plan.



02

Analysis of the present situation

looking into both the internal and the external environments of LHI, particularly the opportunities it could tap into and the threats that could affect its performance.



03

Determination of the strategic direction going forward

including reviewing the vision and mission statements, as well as the core values; choosing appropriate strategies; anticipating the results to be achieved; and the activities that will produce the results, i.e., using the Result-Based Approach to planning.



Strategic Expansion

This Strategic Plan seeks to build on LHI's achievements, boost resource mobilisation from various sources, and expand collaboration and influence beyond current regions. The Plan considers the current and anticipated national context; LHI's internal environment; the scope and nature of intended expansion; and both available and projected resources.



Adaptive Execution

LHI will remain flexible and responsive to the changing environment and review the Plan as necessary if the operating context changes, or the basic assumptions on which the Plan is premised no longer hold. LHI will also develop its Annual Operational/Implementation Plan, in addition to a Monitoring and Evaluation (M&E) Plan, from the Strategic Plan to operationalise it.

2.0

Context & Operating Environment of LHI



2.0 Context & Operating Environment of LHI



A critical analysis of the operating environment is essential when conducting a strategy review and planning to move the organisation to the next level of growth and development. This includes an X-ray of both the internal and external environments in which the organisation exists and carries out its work.

2.1 Global, national, and local situations and trends in the thematic areas of LHI: (Opportunities and Challenges)

2.1.1 Health



In most northern Nigerian states, particularly those where LHI operates, the healthcare system is confronted with significant infrastructure and service delivery challenges. These include elevated maternal and child mortality rates, limited access to healthcare facilities, and insufficient government health budget allocations relative to international standards. Maternal mortality in many northern states exceeds 1,000 deaths per 100,000 live births, compared to the national average of 512. Infant mortality rates surpass 100 per 1,000 live births, largely due to inadequate immunisation coverage, malnutrition, and restricted access to skilled care. Numerous Primary Healthcare Centres (PHCs) lack essential amenities such as clean water, electricity, and functional equipment. Rural areas are especially underserved, with residents facing long travel distances to reach healthcare facilities. There is also a critical shortage of medical personnel, with doctor-to-patient ratios significantly below WHO recommendations.

In addition to the above-mentioned factors, there are other socio-economic factors that further worsen the healthcare situation. These include cultural practices that cause delay, particularly for married women, to access healthcare facilities; low coverage of health insurance, leading to high out-of-pocket medical expenses; and poverty, leading to malnutrition, especially for children. There is also a rising wave of mental health issues aggravated by insecurity and the displacement of people.

2.1.2 Education

Nigeria currently has the largest number of out-of-school children globally, estimated at 18.3 million. Approximately 73% of these children are in the northern regions, with 45% in the North-west and 28% in the North-east. Literacy rates in these areas remain significantly below the national average. Northern states generally allocate 5–10% of their budgets to education; however, a substantial portion is directed



toward recurrent expenditures such as salaries and overheads, rather than infrastructure development, teacher training, or curriculum improvement. Many schools, particularly in rural areas, lack qualified instructors, and most teachers have not received training in digital learning. Most schools are without computers and have limited access to the internet. Parental and community engagement in school governance is minimal, which impacts accountability. Factors such as early marriage, child labour, and traditional religious schooling conflict with formal education. Insurgency and banditry in the North-east and North-west have led to the destruction of educational facilities and the displacement of families.

These circumstances contribute to a population with limited educational attainment, reduced workforce productivity, elevated poverty and unemployment rates, and increased vulnerability to recruitment by extremist groups. Girls face greater challenges, as cultural practices and insecurity frequently hinder their access to education. Without comprehensive reforms in the education sector, Nigeria risks exacerbating poverty, widening the skills gap within the labour market, and perpetuating instability for future generations.

2.1.3 Livelihood



The World Bank report (2025) puts Nigeria's poverty rate at 30.9% and projects that this could rise to 62% by the end of 2026, meaning that about 141 million Nigerians will be living in poverty, and that this increase is driven by persistent inflation, especially food prices, and sluggish economic growth. Many Nigerians, especially the marginalised and vulnerable rural poor that LHI serves lack access to basic education and infrastructure, such as electricity, safe drinking water, and improved sanitation. The unemployment rate is high. As a result of this, a great number of young people now get themselves engaged in criminal activities such as prostitution, robbery, kidnapping, and insurgency as a means of survival. There is an exodus of Nigerians migrating out of the country through dangerous routes, in which many people, including children, have lost their lives in search of greener pastures.

There is a general low level of digital literacy in the community in most LHI project states. Most women in the community lack basic/vocational skills for income generation. In addition, many who have learnt some skills lack access to credit facilities.



As much as governments at the various levels are trying to provide the needed social amenities, the ever-growing population makes these amenities grossly inadequate. An increase in fuel price equally adds to the costs of production and transportation, another factor in the inflation equation.



2.1.4 Food Security



Agriculture accounts for about 25-30% of Nigeria's GDP, yet food security remains one of the country's most pressing challenges. Despite vast arable land and a large farming population, Nigeria struggles to feed itself sustainably. Roughly 70% of rural households depend on farming for their livelihoods. Main crops grown include maize, rice, sorghum, millet, cassava, yams, and cowpea. Cash crops include cocoa, palm oil, and groundnuts, while livestock includes cattle, sheep, goats, and aquaculture. Nigeria is food insecure as over 25 million Nigerians are projected to face acute food insecurity in 2026.

Despite being Africa's largest producer of cassava and yams, Nigeria imports large quantities of wheat, rice, and dairy. Food inflation is persistently high, eroding household purchasing power. Insurgency, banditry, and flooding/droughts disrupt farming and food distribution.

Most farmers rely on rain-fed, subsistence farming with limited mechanization. Up to 40% of crops are lost due to poor storage and transport infrastructure. There is limited access to agricultural credit and modern inputs. There is not much value addition as most farmers sell their produce raw. During the off-season, there is usually a shortage of agricultural produce in the market, characterized by high prices. Agronomic practices have remained largely traditional among farmers, with attendant low productivity rates. Cultural barriers in some parts of the country limit women's participation in agriculture.



The use of modern implements, improved varieties of seeds, cuttings, and livestock is just becoming popular through an increasing rate of adoption by a few demonstration/innovation champions. 'Smart agriculture' that makes use of resilient crops developed via the use of biotechnology, weather prediction through artificial intelligence, and irrigation (greenhouse technology) is yet to be adopted by the majority of farmers. There are also weak market linkages, resulting in farmers' inability to maximise the benefits derivable from the sale of their produce beyond their local markets.

The effects of climate change is now being felt in many ways, including the destruction of properties and loss of lives through communal conflicts, conflicts necessitated by control for land and natural resources, floods, and other natural disasters.

Due to deforestation, indiscriminate bush burning, and desert encroachment in the northern part of the country, there is pressure on the use of land in the rainforest and savanna belts of the country, which often leads to clashes between herdsman and farmers. There is insecurity across all the geopolitical regions of the country, ranging from farmers-herdsman clashes to banditry, cattle rustling, and kidnapping. Farmers do not feel safe to go to their farms, creating a situation of looming food scarcity and high food prices, which is further compounded by displacements

There is a high level of ignorance of the effects of climate change on the environment. Awareness on the use of alternative sources of energy, such as solar, is still low. Indiscriminate disposal of plastic and polythene waste remains a worrisome issue.

2.1.5 Social inclusion



The Federal Government of Nigeria has declared that social inclusion will be entrenched as a permanent feature of governance. Practical strategies such as the Nigeria for Women Programme Scale-Up (NFWP-SU) were launched in February 2026 to expand women's access to finance, skills, and opportunities, placing women at the centre of national planning. These declarations and programmes, and others like them, are aimed at expanding access to credit, education, and leadership roles, job creation, skills development, and civic participation to strengthen welfare systems to support vulnerable households, ensuring marginalized groups (rural poor, persons with disabilities, etc.) are represented in policymaking. There are regional disparities in gender and social inclusion in Nigeria. Northern Nigeria faces higher poverty and exclusion rates compared to the South. Cultural barriers still limit women's participation in education and employment.



Conflict and displacement in the North further reduce access to social services. Growing use of digital platforms for service delivery risks excluding populations with low digital access or literacy. Rising poverty and inequality disproportionately affect already marginalised groups. Also, climate shocks, including flooding, fire disasters, and drought, increase the vulnerability of groups who have limited coping mechanisms.

2.1.6 Protection



Many people are unaware of, or cannot defend, their fundamental human rights. Many are unaware of the legal frameworks that exist to safeguard them from human rights abuses. Certain bad cultural practices, such as ill-treatment of widows, wife-inheritance, and denial of female rights to inheritance, constitute a violation of the rights of the affected persons. Gender stereotypes exist, spousal battery and other abuses like these are often suppressed under the culture of silence. Increased poverty has led to rising cases of sexual and gender-based violence and child early and forced marriages in society.

Protection refers to removing and/or reducing vulnerabilities from harm and abuse. It is the systems and programmes societies put in place to reduce poverty, vulnerability, and inequality of power by providing nets and resilience against factors to enhances vulnerabilities such as unemployment, illness, disability, or displacement. It is a cornerstone of inclusive development worldwide. It is the duty of the government and concerned stakeholders to institute and operationalize policies, regulations, and measures to guarantee protection for the vulnerable within society. Examples of such programmes put in place by governments include mandatory education for under-18s, school feeding, and free legal aids are designed to reduce poverty, improve living conditions, and provide safety nets for vulnerable groups.

However, there are challenges to protection. These include poor and low knowledge of instituted policies, rights, poor households' income remain excluded, because often than not, beneficiaries are chosen along political party lines; harmful gender norms that increase the risk of sexual and gender-based violence (SGBV) against women, girls, and teenage boys; lack of mobile phones and toll-free lines to report SGBV cases; and weak political will to address GBV cases. Flooding and violent attacks by armed bandits also lead to the displacement of families, thus increasing protection risk in the camp and host communities. Northern Nigeria faces higher poverty and weaker access to social protection.

2.2 Internal Environment of LHI – (Strengths and Weaknesses)

The evaluation of LHI's internal environment focused on identifying organisational strengths and weaknesses, assessing deficiencies in project design and planning processes.



Strengths

The strengths include good organisational leadership; standard office complex owned by LHI in Sokoto, Kebbi, and Yobe States, and standard rented apartments in the other states; adequate working tools (furniture, computers, and accessories, ICT infrastructure, and internet access); and suitably qualified and experienced staff. Strengths include staff expertise, extensive project experience, and effective engagement with external stakeholders, fostering strong relationships with government and communities.



Weakness

Weaknesses needing improvement include insufficient office space in Zamfara, weak monitoring and supervision, and inadequate staff appraisal and development. Others include unsustainable funding support, as funding is often tied to projects; gaps in safety and security apparatus; weak documentation of programme outcomes/impact; and inadequate national visibility. See details of SWOT analysis and how to address the issues of concern in [Appendix 8.2](#).

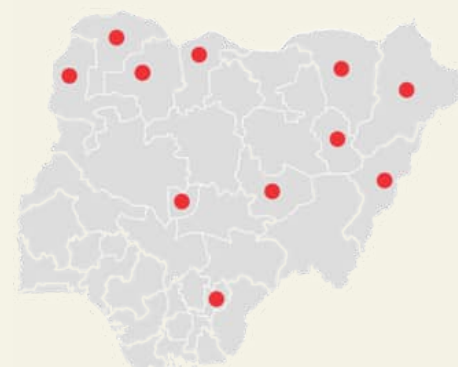
2.3 Target Groups and Beneficiaries

The primary beneficiaries of LHI's services and interventions are the vulnerable people, especially marginalised communities, women, girlchild, people with disabilities, displaced populations, and others who are disadvantaged in one form or another



2.3 Focus of Geographical coverage

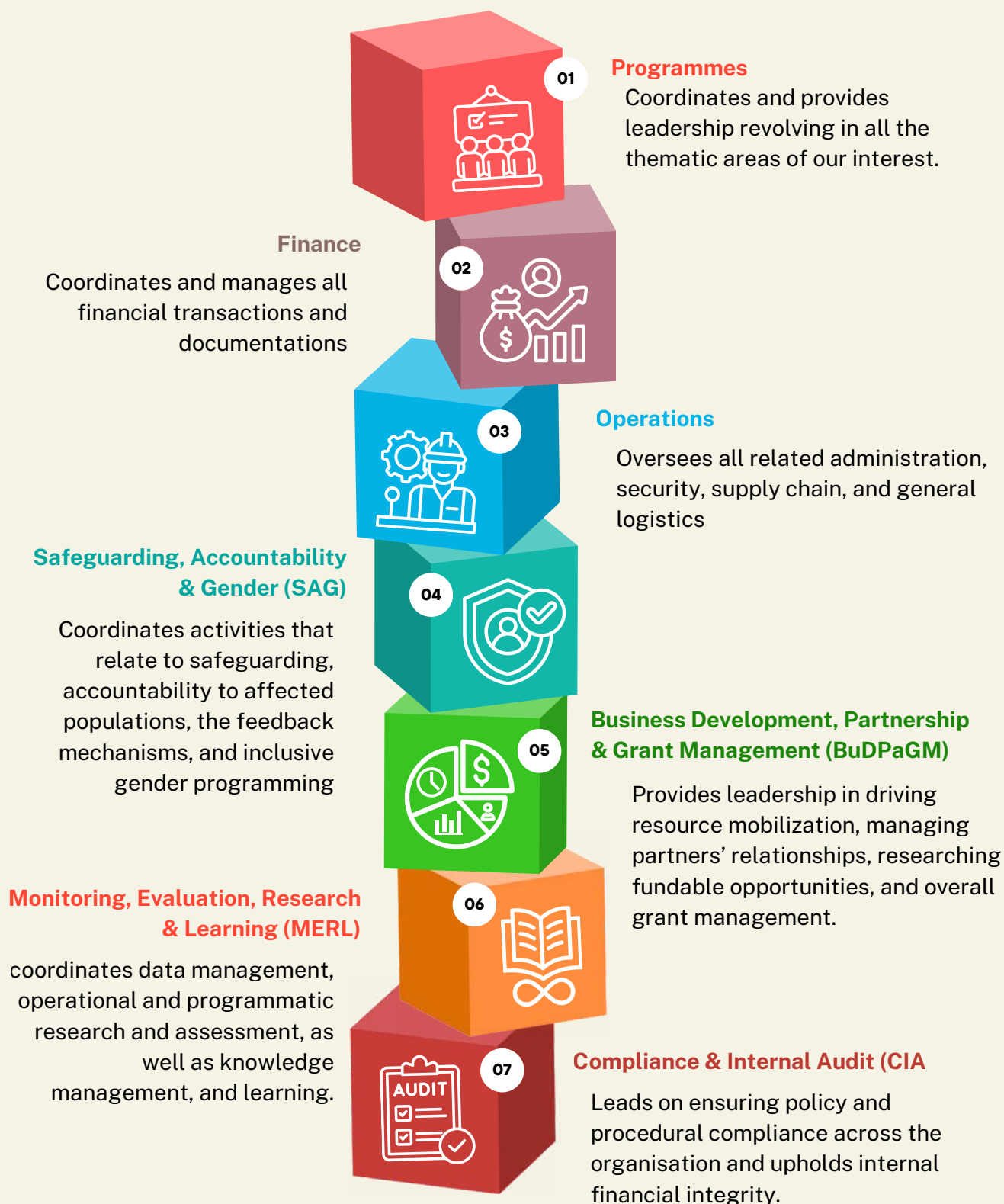
LHI has its **Head Office** at Goshen Development Centre, Tamaje, **Sokoto**. Field/Project Offices are in other States, based on their strategic positioning or projects' contractual agreements reached with funding partners. Besides Sokoto, where the LHI head office is and from where other project sites are coordinated, LHI has programme footprints in **Adamawa, Bauchi, Borno, Ebonyi, Katsina, Kebbi, Plateau, Yobe, and Zamfara States**, as well as the **FCT**. LHI hopes to maintain this mode of operation in this Plan period. Expansion to **Benue and Kaduna** states will be based on funding availability.



However, LHI will endeavour to consolidate on its achievements and sustain its impact in states where it already has presence, and such states will most likely be prioritised/targeted for interventions ahead of other states.

2.5 Strategic Units

Life Helpers has used various structures to maintain optimal performance, always following its organogram. To maximise effectiveness, an efficient workforce and quality service delivery to our targeted clients and beneficiaries, LHI is structured into the following Units:



2.6 Strategic Imperatives for LHI in the Plan Phase (2026-2030)

Over the next phase, LHI will give due priority to addressing the following strategic interventions:



Programmatic

Deepen the understanding and competence of technical staff around the newly reorganised scope of programmes representing the present six (6) thematic areas of Health, Education, Livelihood, Food Security, Gender & Social Inclusion, and Social Protection.

Institutionalise quality improvement / assurance practices and establish a framework that will be used to conduct proper monitoring and evaluation of programme outputs and outcomes.

Strengthen LHI's capacity to be able to use advocacy effectively as a complementary strategy to achieve programme goals and objectives.

Conduct operations research that will provide current and accurate data that will lend credence to the issues LHI is advocating for

Implement robust Monitoring, Evaluation, Accountability, and Learning (MEAL) to properly showcase the achievements of LHI and the impact of the programmes and projects being implemented.

Invest more in ICT to improve the work of LHI and its strategic partners.



Organisational Capacity Strengthening

1

Amend the LHI Constitution to align with some of the best practices and procedures that have been recently adopted, and to reflect the names of new BoT members that were co-opted.

2

Review LHI's organisational structure to become much more simplified, and to reflect the current realities in terms of programmes and the scope of operations.

3

Strengthen the capacity of the human resources: Board, Staff, and Volunteers through exposure, training, and regular performance assessment.

4

Expand the infrastructure – office space, equipment, and vehicles, especially in project states, and in the liaison office.

5

Improve / Enhance welfare of staff – salary review, and other welfare packages to remain competitive, and be able to attract the best hands in the industry.

6

Improve organisational documentation, communication, publicity, and visibility.

See more details in the Options for Growth and Development in [Appendix #5](#)

3.0

Strategic Direction & Focus of LHI [2026-2030]



3.1 LHI's Vision, Mission, and Values



The Vision

"A more fulfilled life for everyone"



The Mission

"To be a leading non-governmental organisation working to maximize all opportunities to empower marginalized people"



The Core Value

- **Love** We passionately foster a friendly working environment that promotes unity and kindness as we exhibit professionalism and excellence in our services.
- **Honesty** We act and communicate clearly and always honour our commitments.
- **Inclusion** We welcome all individuals without discrimination and ensure equal access and opportunities to our clients and staff.



Our Philosophy

Touching Lives; Transforming Households; Impacting communities.

Putting a Smile on a Face!!

3.2 Key Strategies to drive the Plan



LHI will use the following key strategies to operationalise the Strategic Plan.



Systems strengthening

In most of its interventions, and as part of our sustainable pathways, LHI will focus on working with existing systems of government at all levels, and structures within the communities of its interest, strengthening the operating systems (financial, groups/associations management, community protection structures, procurement and supply chain management, data management, etc.) in each institution it is supporting. This is because a strengthened system better ensures survival beyond the project-supported period. Capacity assessments will be conducted before commencing an intervention. This is to enable a tailor-made intervention appropriately. LHI will use training by way of demonstration, workshops, and seminars to increase the knowledge and skills of beneficiaries to be able to adopt and practice new concepts and ideas, such as Climate-smart agriculture, vocational skills, entrepreneurial and financial education, child empowerment and life skill development, and case management in terms of protection of vulnerable members of the society.



Service delivery

Where necessary and strategic, LHI will intervene directly by providing the needed services not to completely replace, but to complement the efforts of the duty bearers at the state and local levels. Such direct service provision would be in the areas of WASH facilities, nutrition support, education, or agriculture infrastructure support, and other areas in line with our overall programmatic goals and objectives, as well as where the intervention will lead to the achievement of significant outcomes.



Advocacy

LHI will advocate to the relevant government arm for policy formulation, regulation, and action to support social initiatives that improve conditions for vulnerable and marginalised groups. Advocacy will also be one of the main strategies to canvass for inclusive governance at all levels, including community and political space.



Community mobilisation / sensitisation and engagement

LHI will promote positive behaviour by using BCC materials, community outreach, and media to encourage healthier choices, school enrolment, and participation in livelihood improvement programs. Community structures will also be engaged to sustain inclusive mechanisms for protecting vulnerable groups.



Networking and Collaboration

LHI will adopt networking and collaboration as a strategy for linking up with relevant non-governmental organisations, community groups, government ministries, departments, and agencies to improve coverage and access to its service delivery efforts and impact.



Organisational capacity development

LHI is committed to giving equal emphasis to organisational capacity development and programme development. Accordingly, LHI will make every effort to strengthen its organisational governance, human resource development, resource mobilisation, infrastructure and facilities, communication and networking, as well as monitoring and evaluation processes. These initiatives will ensure that LHI is well-equipped to implement its strategic plan and programmes efficiently, while effectively addressing internal capacity gaps.



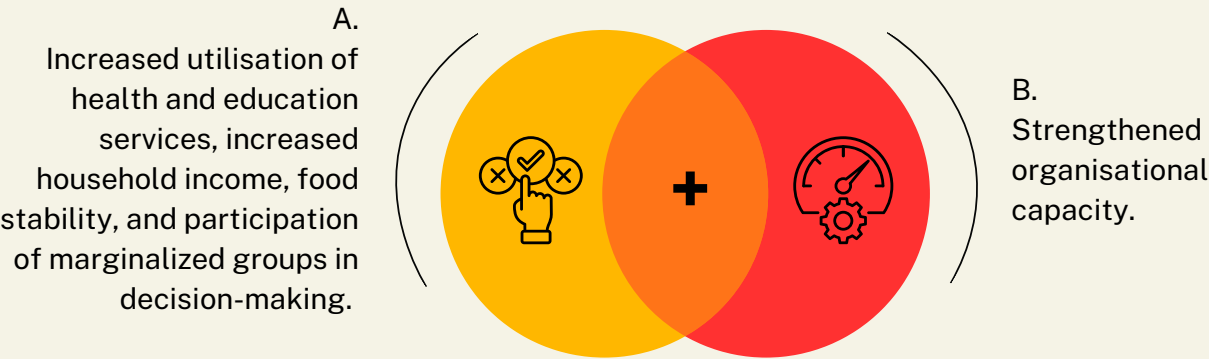
Research, documentation, and publicity

LHI will conduct operations research to investigate and gather data and information to inform programme planning and decision-making. Primary and secondary data will be sourced to undertake evidence-based advocacy to policymakers and duty bearers on behalf of the marginalized populace, to back up their demands for socio-economic benefits. Documentation and publicity will educate the public about the work and achievements of LHI and will also serve as a marketing tool to attract partnerships and funding support.

3.3 Programmatic & Institutional Capacity Areas, and Expected Outcomes



The overall goal of this strategic plan is **improved well-being, resilience, and inclusion of vulnerable populations in communities where LHI operates**. To achieve this, two major categories of outcomes must be achieved, these are:



The following is a summary of the strategic programme and institutional capacity areas, and the expected results.

Table 1: LHI Programme & Institutional Capacity Areas Results Matrix

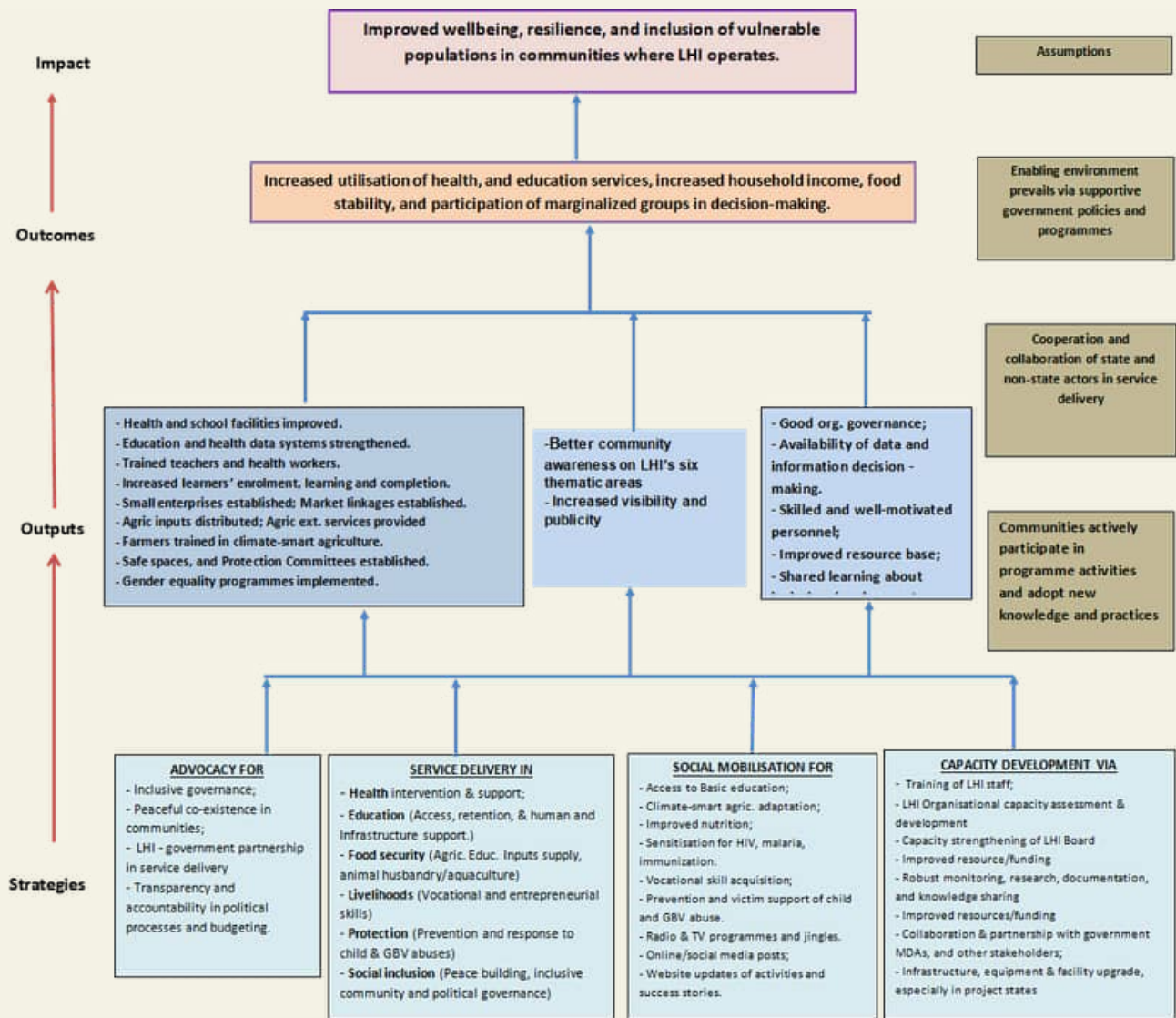
Monitoring, Evaluation,... Improved data processes and m...	Partnership and net... Effective partnership and...	Social inclusion Increased social incl...	Infrastructure... Adequate and condu...	Food secur... Increased food...
Protection Improved protection, safety,...	Organisational Comm... Increased visibility and publi...	Financial management Efficient management of or...	Fund develop... Increased and dive...	Educ... Increase...
		Livelihood Improved household econo...	Human re... Increased pro...	

Table 1: LHI Programme & Institutional Capacity Areas Results Matrix

A. Programmes Outcomes: Increased utilisation of health, and education services, increased household income, food stability, and participation of marginalized groups in decision-making.		
	Programme Area	Expected Results
1	Health	Improved access to quality healthcare services and enhanced health outcomes for all health seekers
2	Education	Increased access to basic education and improved learning outcomes
3	Livelihood	Improved household economic resilience and income generation
4	Food security	Increased food security and sustainable agricultural productivity
5	Social inclusion	Increased social inclusion and equitable participation in development opportunities
6	Protection	Improved protection, safety, and dignity of vulnerable populations
B. Organisational Capacity Development: Enhanced organisational capacity		
	Capacity areas	Expected results
1	Organisational leadership & governance	Improved governance and administrative procedures
2	Human resource development	Increased productivity and an efficient workforce
3	Fund development/ Resource mobilisation	Increased and diversified sources of income/funds
4	Financial management	Efficient management of organisational financial resources
5	Infrastructure and facilities development	Adequate and conducive work environment across all locations
6	Organisational Communications	Increased visibility and publicity
7	Partnership and networking	Effective partnership and expansion of services to target beneficiaries
8	Monitoring, Evaluation, Research & Learning (MERL)	Improved data processes and management for information and decisions-making

See details of Programme areas, components, and expected outcomes in Appendices 1 & 2
A graphical representation of how these expected results connect with each other, and the assumptions surrounding the linkages is presented in the Theory of Change below:

3.4 LHI Theory of Change



4.0

Organisational Governance & Management Structure Of LHI (2026-2030)





4.1 Organisational Governance & Management Structure Of LHI (2026-2030)

LHI had planned to expand its workforce internationally, but the recent industry changes and realities have made such plans highly unreasonable, and the plan has been shelved. The focus is now on sustainable growth within the country, which offers more realistic opportunities for expansion.



4.2 Organisational Structure of LHI

LHI had planned to expand its workforce internationally, but the recent industry changes and realities have made such plans highly unreasonable, and the plan has been shelved. The focus is now on sustainable growth within the country, which offers more realistic opportunities for expansion.



5.0

Key Assumptions & Possible Risk Factors



5.1 Key Assumptions & Possible Risk Factors

In addition to the assumptions outlined in LHI's Theory of Change, which are essential for achieving the anticipated Outputs, Outcomes, and Impact, several other significant assumptions underpin LHI's capacity to implement this Strategic Plan effectively.



These key assumptions include:

- 
Democratic Rights

That the Government of Nigeria remains democratic and allows the people to enjoy their fundamental human rights as guaranteed in Nigeria's Constitution, insofar as these are exercised within the ambit of the law.
- 
SDG Partnership

That the Government of Nigeria and its MDAs are interested in and are willing to genuinely commit to supporting the global agenda of Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), and they will create the enabling environment for non-state actors to play active roles that will contribute to the achievement of the SDGs.
- 
National Security

That there is a reasonable level of peace and security that allows freedom of movement and conduct of activities in communities all over the country, including access to Correctional Institutions.

These assumptions are crucial for achieving the outcomes in this Plan; if they fail, implementation will be significantly hindered.

Key risks identified include limited community engagement, insufficient funding, and staff turnover. LHI has included mitigation strategies in the strategic plan to address these issues.

6.0

Monitoring, Evaluation, Reviewing, & Reporting Protocol

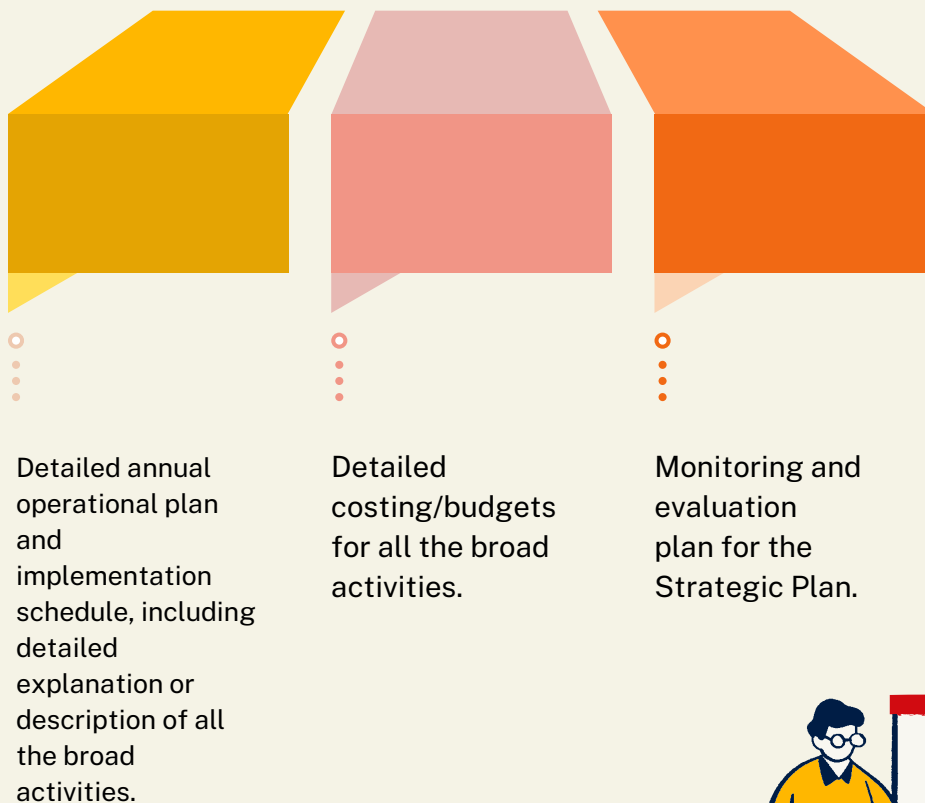


6.0 Monitoring, Evaluation, Reviewing, And Reporting Protocol



The following describes the role of Monitoring, Evaluation, and Review for LHI's success in using this strategy document. It highlights steps needed to ease monitoring, evaluation, and review efforts basic to tracking the outputs, outcomes, and impact of LHI's work.

To ease the monitoring and evaluation tasks, LHI will first ensure the development of the following project documents:



These management documents will be 'living documents' that will be subject to regular, but informed revisions in the light of changing circumstances in LHI's internal and external environments during the life of this strategic plan. Such regular revisions could be done quarterly, or every six months, and significant changes will be subject to ratification by the leadership of LHI.



7.0

Conclusion





7.0 Conclusion

In conclusion, this Strategic Plan (2026-2030) is realistic and achievable within the financial, technical and management capabilities that LHI presently has and can attract during the period.

The plan will consolidate on the achievements recorded in the previous phase and will probably expand the work of LHI beyond its current project states. It will ultimately lay the foundation for a longer-term sustainable future.

The Plan should be regarded as a living document that will remain relevant until its completion in 2030, and lessons learned from its implementation will form inputs into future Strategic Plans.



8.0

Appendices



8.1 Environmental Analysis –Using the STEEP(G)L approach

S/N	THEMATIC	STEEP (G) L	LHI Response / How to Take Advantage
1	Health	Social:	• Develop community-based mental health support programs • Organise free community health outreach and screening days
		• Rising mental health issues due to displacement • Cultural beliefs delay access to services at the PHC • Family disorder and disharmony	
		Technology	• Partner with tech companies for affordable health tech in software and devices • Power health facilities using solar • Mobile health (mHealth) using SMS • Solarization of the facility of service
		• High cost of health tech devices (e.g. imaging device, MRI etc.) • Limited access to digital gadgets and low digital literacy among older residents • Poor electricity is affecting medical services and the storage of cold	
		Economic	• LHI will be partnering with other stakeholders to provide free essential health services • Promote enrolment in the NHIS scheme • Partner with state MDAs to provide free/subsidised drugs through DRF • Promote the setting up of a home garden
		• Heavy impact of inflation on transport, commodities • High out-of-pocket medical expenses • High cost of medical commodities • Poverty leading to malnutrition	
		Environmental	• Community outreaches to the communities and setting up of mobile clinics to reach flooded areas • Community clean-up campaigns
		• Flooding in S/Birni and many other communities we work causing disease outbreaks, difficulty in accessing services • Malaria outbreak due to stagnant water	
2	Education	Political	• Align community health program with government PHC priorities • Monitor policy update and apply for gov't health grants • Conduct supportive supervision to enhance the capacity of existing or available health staffs
		• Gov't support for PHC and the existence of 1 PHC per ward • Political interference by replacing trained staff in the facility with untrained • Political changes affecting program continuity, • Strengthen partnership legally with relevant MDAs	
		• STEEP (G) L	

S/N	THEMATIC	STEEP (G) L	LHI Response / How to Take Advantage
2	Education	Social	- Create partnerships with industry for internships and real-world learning - Girls' education advocacy programs and community sensitisation of the importance of education
		- Skills mismatch between education and workforce needs - Child labour affecting school attendance - Early marriage affects girls' education	
		Technology	- Use AI and adaptive learning platforms to personalize education - Partner with the donor to equip the school with technological devices - Conduct capacity building for teacher on ICT
		- Overreliance on technology reduces critical thinking - Teachers not trained in digital learning - Schools lack computers and the internet	
		Economic	- Promote entrepreneurship education - Micro-support for the family to reduce child labour - Fundraising for school renovation
		- Parent cannot afford school fees - Children supporting family income instead of school - Poor and delayed teacher salary - Skills gap in the labor market	
		Environmental	- Build relationships with education authorities and policymakers - Tree planting for shade and environmental improvement
		- Fatigue in students due to poor ventilation and climate change - Flooding disrupts school attendance - Availability of physical buildings to be used for a classroom in many communities	
		Political	- Increase Village Savings and Loan Associations (VSLA) across our implementing locations. - Teach Basic Skills Development (Basic literacy and numeracy, financial management skills, Simple business planning knowledge, and technical livelihood skills)
		- Schools affected by extreme weather disruptions - Government budget cuts affecting schools and universities	
3	Livelihood	STEEP (G) L	

S/N	THEMETIC	STEEP (G) L	LHI Response / How to Take Advantage
3	Livelihood	Social:	- Engage Traditional & Religious Leaders - Use examples from similar communities where women's involvement has improved household income. - Frame women's participation as family economic strengthening, not gender competition.
		Cultural barrier, especially to women's participation in agriculture in the community, coupled with Cultural preference	
		Technology:	- LHI Support in capacity building with basic digital training skills. - LHI support in identifying trades in demand locally (tailoring, welding, mechanics, poultry, phone repair, Agro-processing, solar installation, etc.)
		- Low digital literacy in the community - Absence of vocational skills - Lack of access to credit facilities, especially for women folk - Most women at the community lacks basic skills and poor income generation - Network fluctuations	
		Economical:	- Increase Village Savings and Loan Associations (VSLA) across our implementing locations. - Teach Basic Skills Development (Basic literacy and numeracy, financial management skills, Simple business planning knowledge, and technical livelihood skills)
		- Absence of vocational skills - Lack of access to credit facilities, especially for women folk - Most women in the community lack basic skills and have poor income-generation skills	
		Political:	- Engage local government authorities to support women-inclusive policies. - Advocate for improved rural infrastructure and education services. - Community Monitoring Mechanisms - Establish community committees to monitor project implementation. - Promote transparency through public accountability forums. - Education Support Programs - Provide scholarships for girls. - Promote adult literacy programs for women. - Support school retention initiatives.
		- Change in governance affecting continuity of programs. - Corruption and mismanagement of public resources. - Poor access to governance education, especially in hinterland communities.	
4	Food Security	Legal:	- Conduct community education on women's rights and GBV laws. - Simplify legal information into local languages. - Partner with legal aid organisations to provide pro bono services. - Strengthen referral systems between police, health centers, and community leaders.
		- Weak legal action against perpetrators of gender-based violence. - Limited awareness of legal rights among women	

S/N	THEMATIC	STEEP(G)L	LHI Response / How to Take Advantage
4	Food Security	Social:	- LHI is engaging traditional and religious leaders early. - Frame women's participation as household economic strengthening. - LHI supports Conducting community nutrition education sessions. and Train women groups on food demonstration and child feeding practices - LHI Supports in facilitating community dialogue platforms and Promote conflict resolution committees.
		- Cultural barriers limiting women's participation in agriculture - Low digital literacy - Poor nutrition awareness - Conflict between farmers and herders - Youth unemployment leading to insecurity	
		Economic:	- LHI would provide vocational and technical skills training. - Link youth to agriculture value chains. - Provide entrepreneurship and financial literacy. - Conduct value chain and market assessments and facilitate direct buyer-producer linkages. - Promote crop diversification and climate-smart agriculture. - Encourage household food storage systems. - Build contingency buffers into project budgets. - Negotiate framework agreements with suppliers.
		- Weak market linkages - High inflation and food price volatility - Limited access to agricultural inputs - Currency instability affecting procurement	
		Technology:	
		- Limited irrigation infrastructure - Poor storage and post-harvest technology - Limited access to improved seeds and farming inputs. - Low digital literacy - Limited access to climate-smart agriculture tools	- Link farmers through digital platforms to certified input suppliers. - Provision of solar-based radios for information access - Promote small-scale irrigation (solar pumps, treadle pumps). - Introduce simple digital market/extension tools. - Provide basic digital skills training.
		Environment:	
		- Flooding in some Area E.g. Sabon-birni Goronyo and Rabah, and around communities in Kebbi, Yobe or Borno, - Insecurity restricting access to farmlands (Isa, Sabon-birni, Rabah, Goronyo, Tangaza e.t.c), which lead Displacement of farming communities	- Establish community warehouses. - Demonstrate improved seed performance through pilot plots. - Train communities on early warning systems. - Train the community on how to advocate for boats and life jackets - Support cluster farming near communities. - Encourage backyard/kitchen, gardening models.

S/N	THEMATIC	STEEP(G)L	LHI Response / How to Take Advantage
4	Food Security	Political:	• Institutionalize partnerships through MoU, not informal relationships. • Train multiple focal persons (not just one). • Develop clear, documented beneficiary selection criteria, and use Word development committees. • Document the full selection process. • Establish multi-stakeholder coordination platforms. • Share quarterly reports with all relevant agencies. • LHI conducts regular security risk assessments. • Use local staff and community focal points. • Adjust field visit schedules based on security updates.
		• Change in government officials or key stakeholders. • Political interference in beneficiary selection • Weak coordination between government agencies • Insecurity and armed groups in rural areas	
		Legal:	
		• Weak enforcement of agricultural quality standards.	• LHI support in training farmers and cooperatives on national quality standards
5	Social Inclusion	Social:	• Mainstream social inclusion and equity across all programmes, with intentional targeting of marginalised groups. • Strengthen community participation and feedback mechanisms to amplify the voices of excluded populations.
		• Persistent exclusion of women, girls, persons with disabilities (PWDs), and youths.	
		Technological:	• Design programmes that address access barriers (gender, disability, age, displacement status) • Align interventions with national and donor inclusion frameworks to enhance funding competitiveness. • LHI as a community-rooted actor advancing inclusive development.
		• Growing use of digital platforms for service delivery risks excluding populations with low digital access or literacy	
		Economic:	• Provide economic and entrepreneurial orientation to enhance knowledge and skills • Development community pool funding through group dynamics
		• Rising poverty and inequality disproportionately affect already marginalised groups.	
		Environmental:	• Active community engagement on the climate

S/N	THEMATIC	STEEP (G) L	LHI Response / How to Take Advantage
5	Social Inclusion	Environmental:	- Active community engagement on the climate - Promotion of alternative household energy sources - Encouraging planting of economic trees - LHI is collaborating with the State Emergency Management Board (SEMA) to provide support to families affected by flood.
		Climate shocks (Flooding, fire disasters, Drought increase the vulnerability of excluded groups who have limited coping mechanisms.	
		Political/Governance:	- Support through high-level advocacy to the relevant stakeholders - Promote coalition and coordination among marginalised groups
		- Low representation of women & Youth in local governance. - Poor funding access for the marginalised to make a meaningful impact on the political landscape	
		Legal:	- Partnering with Legal Aid, the Ministry of Justice, and all government security agencies. - Community enlightening on rights and privileges
		- Limited access to legal representation for survivors of abuse - Double jeopardy of stigmatization	
6	Protection	Social:	- LHI is creating awareness and dialogue sessions on harmful gender norms. - LHI has provided feedback mechanisms such as a suggestion box and toll-free line. - LHI is supporting communities in effective dialogues on protection and inclusion.
		- Harmful gender norms increasing risk of SGBV against women, girls, and teenage boys - Early marriage to escape poverty, social stigma around age	
		Technology:	- Provision of toll-free lines - Use of digital platforms to mobilize young people as champions
		Lack of mobile phones and toll-free lines is limiting access to GBV hotlines.	

S/N	THEMATIC	STEEP (G) L	LHI Response / How to Take Advantage
6	Protection	Environmental:	- LHI is training and supporting community volunteers on protection standards and referral protocols. - Provision of emergency relief packages
		Flooding led to the displacement of families, thus increasing protection risk in the camp and host communities.	
		Political:	- LHI is supporting legal awareness sessions on rights and protection laws. - Engage in high-level advocacy for policy formation and implementation
		- Weak political will to address GBV cases. - Bureaucratic bottlenecks and/or cover-ups for perpetrators - Poor coordination between police, health and social services.	
		Legal:	- Awareness creation on the laws among community members especially survivors - Strong media campaigns
		Weak enforcement of child protection and VAPP laws.	

8.2 Assessment of the Internal Environment of LHI (SWOT) - Strengths and Weaknesses only.

a. Strengths

S/N.	Capacity Areas	Strengths	How to Build on Strengths
1	Governance & Management [Board, Org. Structure, Policies, Compliance with statutory obligations)	- Active & functional BoT, meeting regularly - Adaptable, responsive, and active senior leadership team - High compliance with statutory (all tax obligations, Insurance Trust, Annual return filing)	- Strengthening of the Board Charter to bridge the gaps for enhanced procedures. - More frequency in physical engagement with the state office staff. - Continuous adherence to statutory protocols

8.2 Assessment of the Internal Environment of LHI (SWOT) - Strengths and Weaknesses only.

a. Strengths

S/N.	Capacity Areas	Strengths	How to Build on Strengths
2	Human Resource (Staff, Volunteers, Salaries, allowances, welfare in general)	• Strong, robust, and adaptive policy, processes, templates, and tools • Systematic and structured capacity strengthening • Competitive pay package – Appropriate intern/volunteer system • Conducive working environment and tools	• Systemic process of enhancing staff knowledge of the processes, procedures, and policy provision • Development of handbook.
3	Technical Capacity, SOPs, Use of ICT, Knowledge Management	• Availability of appropriate, adaptive, responsive program-based policies and SOPs • Availability of ICT infrastructure, personnel, policies, and procedures • Availability of the KM policy and tools	• Continuous investment in the ICT infrastructure • Updating and upgrading Policies and SoPs • Procure more communication gadgets •
4	Resource Mobilization (Proposal, Investments, fundraising)	• Availability of resources through funding from donors and partners. • Active proposal writing and engagement of other INGO on grant sourcing • Funds from investment in NIDAKE Solutions, one of the social enterprise investments • Successful piloting of agricultural farming • Involvement of more program technical staff in proposal development	• Diversification in our thematic focus • Exploration of new collaboration with donor partners • Seeking out more funding from private donors. • Increasing the market share of NIDAKE Solution through an increase in its production, good marketing will lead to an increase in market share and profitability.
5	Equipment, Infrastructure, & Facilities (Offices, computers, internet)	• Availability standard office complex owned by LHI in Sokoto, Kebbi, and Yobe State and standard rented apartments in the other states • Availability of computer laptops for all staff and other gadgets needed to aid staff work. • Availability of unlimited access to the internet in all LHI offices	• Continuous investment in the solar system to improve capacity. • Continuous expansion of the warehouse. • Upgrading of computer laptops and enhanced internet access to all offices

a. Strengths

S/N.	Capacity Areas	Strengths	How to Build on Strengths
5	Equipment, Infrastructure, & Facilities (Offices, computers, internet)	- Availability of solar power systems in almost all offices, which is making LHI go green in the aspect of power supply and reduce cost of energy. - Availability of standard warehouse	- Continuous investment in the solar system to improve capacity. - Continuous expansion of the warehouse. - Upgrading of computer laptops and enhanced internet access to all offices
6	Collaboration and Networking	- Robust strategy in external stakeholders' engagement - Creation of a dedicated Governance designation - Active participation and membership in coalition, associations and networks	Provide specific orientation to staff members on the strategy and relevancy of active membership of association and how to take advantage
7	Communication, Visibility, & Publicity (Website, newsletters, etc.)	- Active visibility through the website and other social media platforms - Functional newsletter quarterly - Responsive and adaptive communication policy and strategy	- Engage, orientate and envision communication staff or team members - Continuous communication infrastructure investment
8	Monitoring, Review, & Evaluation	- Responsive and adaptive MEL Policy and indicators - Robust and adequate data management system - Engagement of experienced and knowledgeable staff members	- Prompt and timely uploading and updating of data - Improving documentation and reporting writing skills

8.2 Assessment of the Internal Environment of LHI (SWOT) - Strengths and Weaknesses only.**b. Weaknesses**

S/N	Capacity Areas	Weaknesses	How to Eliminate / Reduce them
1	Governance & Management [Board, Org. Structure, Policies, Compliance with statutory obligations]	- Weak and poor frequency in oversight functions - Work overload on leadership and program management	- Strengthen Board Charter - Increase Board membership and diversity - Fill in staff gaps in the key technical areas

8.2 Assessment of the Internal Environment of LHI (SWOT) - Strengths and Weaknesses only.

b. Weaknesses

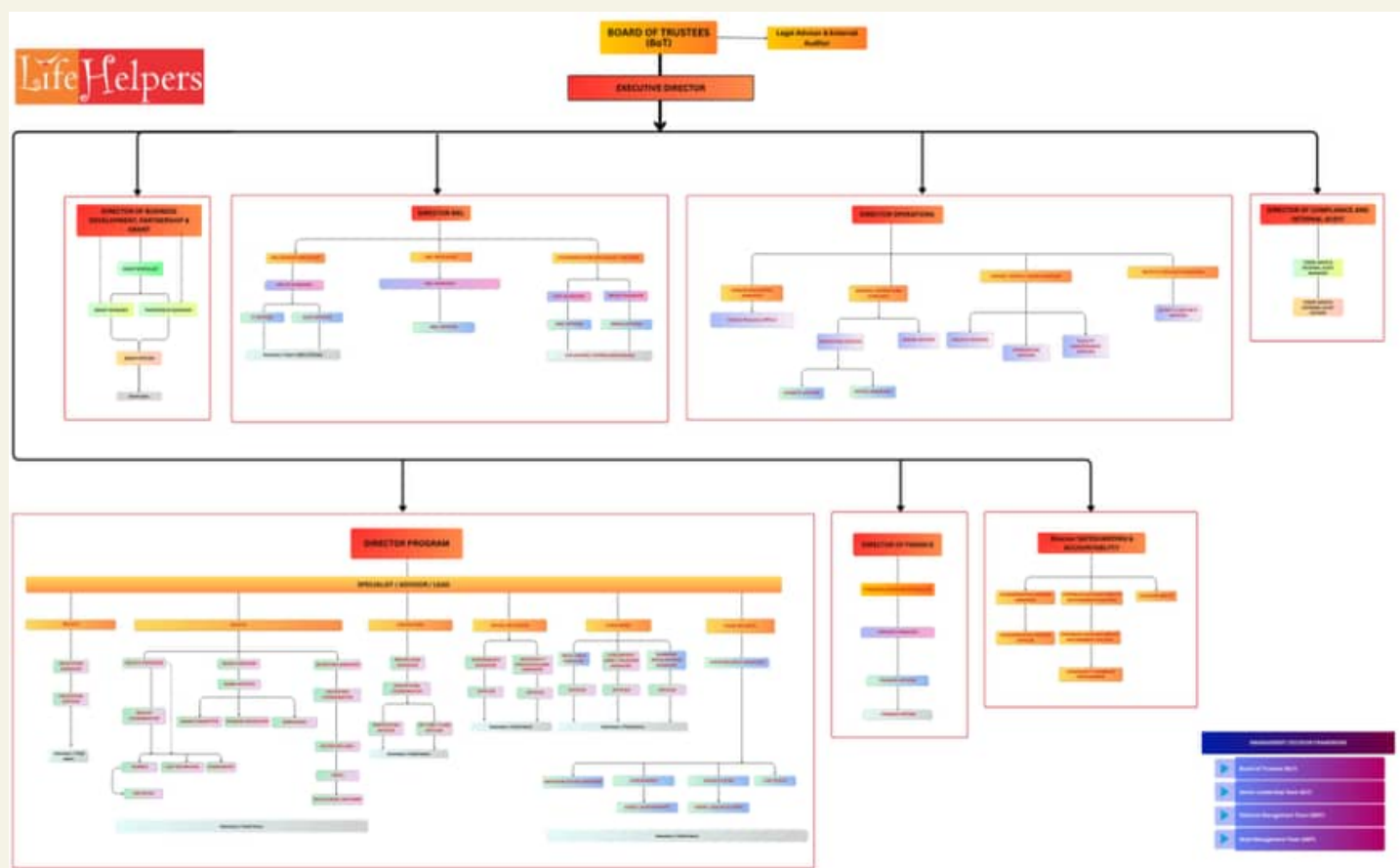
S/N	Capacity Areas	Weaknesses	How to Eliminate / Reduce them
2	Human Resource (Staff, Volunteers, Salaries, allowances, welfare in general)	- No staff handbook - No digital or virtual continuous training/orientation platforms - Salaries tied to projects and impact long-term continuity for staff - Low knowledge of the performance appraising tool - Inability of PA to translate into a tangible growth pathway	- Develop a staff handbook - Develop a self-assessing virtual/online continuous orientation or training content - Orientate middle managers and all staff on performance - Redesign PA to have a growth indicator and impact
3	Technical Capacity, SOPs, Use of ICT, Knowledge Management	- Key gaps in program technical policies & SoPs and attestation - No dedicated funding. Funding tied to key internal areas such as Safeguarding, Accountability & Gender - Obsolete infrastructure - Limited number of staff - Limited training opportunities - Centralization of systems	- Review policies and design an attestation page for the Board Chair and Secretary to sign - Replacement of key infrastructure with a plan - Create or explore online training opportunities and ensure staff participation
4	Resource Mobilisation (Proposal, Investments, fundraising)	- No SON Registration for Nidake - No systemic scouting of funding channels - Workloads on staff involved	Actively pursue SON Registration
5	Equipment, Infrastructure, & Facilities (Offices, computers, internet)	- Obsolete laptops and other gadgets - Inconducive office accommodation in a few state locations, e.g., Zamfara, due to the increased numbers of required project staffing - No dedicated internet device in Bauchi, FCT, Plateau, Kebbi offices	- Systemic replacement of obsolete laptops - Possible provision of a more conducive office accommodation - Provision of dedicated internet where possible (national limited regulations affects)
6	Collaboration and Networking	- Weak national visibility - No strategy in using our products to build a network - Low knowledge of key middle management staff on advocacy and networking communication	- Develop a communication plan which may include hosting media chats, stakeholders' meetings - Organise an orientation meeting on building and sustaining networks

8.2 Assessment of the Internal Environment of LHI (SWOT) - Strengths and Weaknesses only.

b. Weaknesses

S/N	Capacity Areas	Weaknesses	How to Eliminate / Reduce them
7	Communication, Visibility, & Publicity (Website, newsletters, etc.)	- No consistency in the development of a monthly, quarterly, or annual work plan - No performance measurement of the plan - No dedicated funding	- Develop and measure consistently - Develop a Compendium of human impact stories with a compelling writing format
8	Monitoring, Review, & Evaluation	- No quarterly indicator data review meetings - No agreed format or template for the annual report with dedicated responsible staff	Institutionalize a quarterly data review meeting

8.3: Organogram



8.4: Programme areas, Components, Strategies, and Goals Matrix

S/N	Programme Areas	Components	Strategies	Expected Outcomes
1	Health	Human resource support	Systems strengthening	Improved access to quality healthcare services and enhanced health outcomes for all health seekers
			Community engagement	
			Service delivery	
		Health equipment support & pharmaceuticals	Supply Chain Management (Pharmaceuticals, Medical supplies, medical equipment, and warehousing)	
			Outpatient therapeutic feeding programme (OTP)/Supplementation	
		Nutrition support	Nutrition Education & Awareness campaign (Food/ demonstration, Fortification, storage)	
			Maternal, Infant, and Young Child Nutrition (MIYCN)	
			Inpatient therapeutic feeding programme	
			Community level sensitisation & Demand creation (active screening)	
			Community level sensitisation & Demand creation (active screening)	
		Water, Sanitation & Hygiene (WASH)	Infection prevention & control	
			Community WASH	
			WASH infrastructure support	
		Malaria	Seasonal malaria chemoprevention	
			Community mobilisation	
			Data management	
		HIV	HIV prevention	
			HIV early testing and diagnosis	
			Treatment and care	
			Adherence and retention support	
		Immunisation	PHC Systems strengthening	
			Demand creation by gatekeepers	
			Microplanning and community engagement	
2	Education	Equitable Basic Access to quality education	Innovation, Quality, Learning, Retention, Completion, and Transition	Increased access to basic education and improved learning outcomes
		Education Governance and Complementary Education Services	Community mobilisation & Capacity Strengthening (SBMC, CBMC, Mothers Associations, Women Groups)	
			Education support platforms (Girls4Girls, Kids Forum)	
			Education infrastructure support	

8.4: Programme areas, Components, Strategies, and Goals Matrix

S/N	Programme Areas	Components	Strategies	Expected Outcomes
3	Food security	Agriculture	Agricultural education	Increased food security and sustainable agricultural productivity
			Agricultural infrastructure	
			Crop Production (Access to improved seedlings, Fertilisers)	
		Climate adaptation	Early warning systems for drought and food crisis	
			Community mobilisation (tree planting, alternative and renewable energy)	
		Food distribution	Beneficiary targeting	
			Community mobilisation	
			Procurement & Warehousing	
		Animal husbandry & Aquaculture	Community engagement & education (housing, feeding & medicine)	
			Capacity building	
			Pond and water management	
4	Livelihood	Vocational / Technical Skills	Skill acquisition	Improved household economic resilience and income generation
		Groups Savings & Loans Association	Formation and strengthening of Village Saving & Loans Associations	
		Multipurpose Cash Assistance (MPCA)	Strengthening Target beneficiaries	
		Business / Entrepreneurial and Financial Education	Entrepreneurship support	
			Linkage to financial institutions	
5	Protection	Prevention and response to child protection	Community/institutional capacity strengthening (community-based child protection mechanisms)	Improved protection, safety, and dignity of the vulnerable population.
			Coordination	
			Case management	
			Child empowerment and life skill development	
			Positive parenting & caregiver support	
			Birth registration	
			Community mobilisation	
			Data management	
			Case management and individual support	
		Friendly Centers	Child Centers (Establishment and management of centers,	
			Provision of Psychosocial services, including counselling and recreation	

8.4: Programme areas, Components, Strategies, and Goals Matrix

S/N	Programme Areas	Components	Strategies	Expected Outcomes
5	Protection	Prevention and response to GBV	Capacity building Case management and individual support Community awareness and social norms change. Women & girls' empowerment	Improved protection, safety, and dignity of the vulnerable population.
6	Gender & Social inclusion	Governance Peace building High-level advocacy	Community Engagement and Sensitization Advocacy for inclusive governance capacity building and empowerment participatory needs assessment political processes and budgeting Promote transparency and accountability mechanisms Strengthen Institutional Collaboration with Government Structures Enhance citizen engagement in public financial management Support Government Capacity Strengthening Community Education and Engagement Capacity Strengthening Advocacy agenda and framework Technical working groups Practical advocacy Strengthening internal capacity for advocacy	Increased social inclusion and equitable participation in development opportunities

8.5: Institutional Capacity Strengthening

Capacity area	Components	Expected outcomes	Main activities
1. Organisational leadership & Governance	- Development / Review of administrative policies (e.g. Board Manual, Administrative / Operational Handbook, Procurement policy, etc.) - Organisational Structure - Board meetings and Board development activities - Management meetings - Project Management Team Meetings - Corporate Annual Report - Annual Review Meeting - Workforce / Succession Planning	Improved Governance and Administrative Procedures	- Organise periodic training for BOT members on the scope of duties, roles, and responsibilities. - Delegated the Board's Committee members to give reports on the unit during the meeting. - Produce and share Annual reports to relevant stakeholders. - Organise for the conduct of the Annual Financial Audit. - Support BOT members to hold their biannual meetings. - Ensure the BOT approves policies - ED to deliberately build capacity through delegation to prepare for smooth succession.
2. Human resource development	Staff strength: Technical: - Technical / Programme Staff - Admin Staff	Increased productivity from well-motivated staff	- Schedule the recruitment of staff based on needs - Advertise positions, shortlist, and interview candidates - Offer successful candidates their Offer Letters
	Capacity development: - Develop Human Resource Policy/Manual, Staff Handbook - Review Job Description of staff - Regular performance evaluation - In-house Training - External Training and attendance at professional conferences - Employee Reward/Recognition		- Develop and operationalize a performance improvement plan - Conduct Staff annual/biannual appraisal - Organise Proper onboarding and orientation for new staff - Review/Redefine job roles and responsibilities - Update policies to reflect best practices - Continually promote a safe and conducive work environment - Seek opportunities to support staff to attend conferences
	Staff Welfare - Salary structure - Welfare package (Health insurance, Life insurance, Pension, etc.) - Excellence awards - Payment of tax		- Review and reinforce the staff welfare package and reward systems - Reward performance excellence through appropriate mechanisms - Update NHIS for staff annually to accommodate new staff. - Ensure staff tax deductions are remitted to the appropriate authorities and receipts issued to payees
3. Fund development / Resource mobilisation	- Donor mapping and proposal development - Training on proposal and report writing. - Grant management	Increased and diversified sources of income/funds	- Quarterly update of the Donor mapping document. - Task RM Committee members / Management to write at least 2 solicited /unsolicited proposals per month

8.5: Institutional Capacity Strengthening

Capacity area	Components	Expected outcomes	Main activities
3. Fund development / Resource mobilisation	- Grant management - Resource mobilisation policy - Resource mobilisation plan - IGA	Increased and diversified sources of income/funds	- Take action to develop/operationalize the Resource Mobilisation Plan, especially raising the organisation's own means through income-generating activities - Intensify efforts to reactivate the existing vocational skill centres. - Intensify publicity for the existing vocational skill/ICT centres through handbills, social media, etc., to increase patronage - Conduct periodic training of committee members (especially new staff) on resource mobilisation and sustainability
	Infrastructure needs: - Office space: 500-Capacity Conference Hall - Additional Office space to accommodate 20 staff - A resource/ vocational centre - Office facelift with replacement with modern doors and window casements Office equipment 20 - 35 laptops 3 photocopying machines 2 Terabyte storage disks (2) 3 printers (black & white), 1 coloured 2 multimedia projectors 10-1.5hp split A/Cs 5 units of 3-hp Split standing A/Cs 5 Water dispensers - Addition 25kva solar units 3 5Kva Solar units 100kva generator - Remote controller for multimedia / Pointers (4pcs) - Mobile devices for data management - Mobile PAS (2) Office facilities: - Satellite-based internet facility - Radio broadcast facilities - Upgrade office conveniences (restrooms) and 2 additional 20 sets of office tables and chairs 5 office shelves 5 Office cabinets 6 Flipchart stands Vehicles - Hi-Lux vehicles (2) - Toyota Picnic (1) - Motorcycles (3) - Toyota Hummer Bus	Enhanced working environment with increased productivity	- Schedule the development of office physical infrastructure over the plan period. - Include budget for the development of the physical infrastructure in project proposals - Supervise the construction of the infrastructures - Schedule the purchase of office equipment over the plan period. - Include budget for the procurement of the office equipment in project proposals - Procure the office equipment according to the procurement policy. - Schedule the purchase of office facilities over the plan period. - Include budget for the procurement of the office facilities in project proposals - Procure the office facilities according to the procurement policy. - Schedule the purchase of official vehicles over the plan period. - Include budget for the purchase and maintenance of the official vehicles in project proposals - Purchase and maintain the official vehicles according to the procurement and maintenance policies.

8.5: Institutional Capacity Strengthening

Capacity area	Components	Expected outcomes	Main activities
4. Financial management	- Financial management policy - Financial statement - Financial audit - Budget - Procurement - Bank Reconciliation - Compliance with statutory regulations - Internal control	Efficient management of organisational financial resources	- Take deliberate action to classify accounts - Develop and operationalize financial management policy, as well as Procurement Policy. - Set up an Internal Control unit to ensure the exercise of due diligence in the activities, not only financial activities - Review organisational budget at least every six months - Increase the number of pre-qualified vendors - Establish and use online remittance payment system. - Do Petty Cash count at least twice in a month, and bank reconciliation monthly. - Create a Petty cash template. - File Annual Returns at CAC
5. Organisational communication	- Updated website - Presence on social media - Annual Reports - Documentaries - Radio and television appearances - Periodic Newsletters - ICT training - Training on improving written communication skill - Communication policy and Plan	Increased visibility and publicity for LHI	- Encourage members of the staff to regularly engage the organisation's social media handles by liking, commenting and sharing our posts for increased traction. - Run frequent social media sponsored ads campaign. - Purchase necessary tools for social media content creation and live-streaming tools. - Provide a stable Wi-Fi connection - Provide 11th Generation Core i3 – 8 GB Ram, 500 GB SSD, OR 10th Generation Core i7 – 8 GB Ram, 500 GB SSD, or 1 TB HDD Computer. - Produce regular newsletters and Annual Reports - Develop a Communication Policy and Communication Plan and implement them. - Conduct training on IT for staff - Conduct training on improving written communication skills for staff - Develop a Feasibility Report on the establishment of a commercially viable radio station for the organisation
6. Partnership and Networking	- Registration with the appropriate government MDAs - Partnership policy - Directory of possible networks/coalition, and Partners - Referral pathways	Effective partnership and expansion of services to target beneficiaries	- Develop and implement a partnership policy - Develop a directory of networks and coalitions - Register with appropriate agencies at the state and local levels - Collaborate with more CSOs and co-create proposals and programmes

8.5: Institutional Capacity Strengthening

Capacity area	Components	Expected outcomes	Main activities
7. Monitoring, Evaluation, Research & Learning (MERL)	- MERL Strategy Plan - Data management, - Operations research - Documentation of project impact, learning	Improved data management for information and decisions-making	- Develop MERL strategy plan and operationalise it - Develop appropriate tools for data collection. - Validate and analyse data routinely. - Train M & E officers to develop and use workplan/framework for the organisation - Train M & E officers to carryout research and learning - Conduct baseline survey of beneficiaries/ households before any new project starts. - Conduct Midline reviews and Endline evaluations - Conduct Post-distribution monitoring (PDM) - Develop M&E Standard Operating Procedures (SOP) - Conduct step-down training for other staffs. - Back up documents in a standard storage system, e.g., Cloud, Mega. - Continue the regular monthly, quarterly, and annual report sharing with management and other relevant stakeholders. - Produce and develop Success Stories and documentaries on the impact of the activities on the beneficiaries. - Continue weekly review meetings.
8. Safeguarding, Accountability & Gender	- Safeguarding - Feedback Mechanism - Gender - Accountability	Encouraged participation, strengthened feedback practices, and ensured accountability.	- Conduct training and refresher training for the staff and volunteers on AAP/FAM. - Handle and provide a safe and confidential method for individuals to express their complaints/feedback and receive responses. - Conduct a community feedback meeting with the stakeholders. - Consultation meeting with the children, Women and Youth. - Monthly, quarterly/Bi-annual and annual feedback database and narrative report. - Safeguarding risk assessment - Annual/ quarterly Safeguarding and PSEAH Training and Orientation - Annual safeguarding consultation meeting - Translate safeguarding messages into local languages for accessibility - Conduct community sensitization on safeguarding and reporting channels - Develop the safeguarding management database
9. Business Development	- Business Development & Research - Grant Management - Social Enterprises		- Develop the agriculture interventions - Provide the framework for social enterprise

8.6 LHI Options for Growth, Development, and Sustainability

Strategic operational area(s)	Options	Consensus	Additional Opinion
Constitution	- Retain the constitution as it is OR - Amend the constitution to suit our growth chapter	Amend to suit	This will help us to regularize the co-opted BoT members, realign some of the best practices and procedures we have adopted. The process now is quite cumbersome, especially to get it approved by the Corporate Affairs Commission
Status	- Association with no members OR - Membership Association	Association with no members	Over time, we have drifted from a crowd-pulling association into a more formal organisation
Mode of operation	- Direct implementation of activities statewide OR - Work through network partners, OR - Combine both	Combine	Through our growth and influence, coupled with our grant systems, we are positioned to do both
Programme Management approach	- Maintain the status quo (Direct implementation of programs) OR - Grant making and capacity building of CBOs/NGOs OR - Direct implementation + grant making	Direct implementation + grant making	Looking at the emerging challenges in our sector, developing a system to do both is a wiser decision.
Geographical coverage	- Retain current coverage areas OR - Expand to other States	Let both be on the table, including closing down other non-viable state offices	Funding opportunities or mechanisms may be the deciding factors in this. We may need to develop a different working model, like direct remote working without a formal office structure on the ground
Operational base (Office)	- Maintain the current operational structure OR - Create Regional Offices.	Both may be possible	We can have regional offices that is situated in a state but provide control and coordination for multiple states so that we need not be physically present in neighbouring states. However, some prime partners insist on physical presence before consideration for partnership
Programme Scope/focus	- Maintain the status quo and consolidate OR - Expand programme scope (if yes, what are these areas?)	Expand	It was in preparation for this strategic plan development that we expanded our scope to the present 6 thematic areas of Health, Education, Livelihood, Food Security, Social Inclusion and Protection
Programme Strategies	- Maintain status quo OR - Modify and expand strategies (to include what?)	Maintain status	Our present strategies are good to go, except where we only need to develop SOPs for
Targets and beneficiary groups	- Focus on existing target groups OR - Expand the target groups based on programme focus and strategies (provide details)	Focus on existing target groups	These targeted groups we have continue to be the core of interventions and with high business caseloads

8.6 LHI Options for Growth, Development, and Sustainability

Strategic operational area(s)	Options	Consensus	Additional Opinion
Core programme focus areas	· Health and education promotion only · OR · Promotion and service delivery - OR · Both promotion and providing services	Both	Makes us competitive
Health Service Delivery including HCT	· Maintain status quo (Clinic and community-based) OR · Clinic-based alone OR · Community-based alone	Maintain status	Diversified capacity makes us competitive and relevant
Vision and mission	· Retain the current national vision and mission statements OR · Review/revise current vision and mission statements	Retain	Very relevant and speaks about who we are and what we plan to achieve
Core values	· Retain the current core values OR · Review/revise current core values	Retain	Speaks to us and the future
Human resources/staffing	· Maintain status quo OR · Re-staff completely based on programme areas and scope and expected results	A level of re-organisation is required	Due to the anticipated funding and close-out of grant projects, there would be a need to do some sort/to a certain extent, but it would not be a complete overhaul
Organisational Structure	· Retain the current structure · OR · Re-structure completely	Retain	Our current structure was in anticipation of this new strategic plan
Resource mobilisation	· Maintain the status quo - OR · Expand the strategies and sources	Expand strategies and sources	A need to diversify, scope more funding sources, and develop relevant strategies
Materials distribution	· Centralize distribution OR · Decentralize distribution of materials	Both, interchangeably	May need to explore both options, looking at location and cost implications
LHI Secretariat	· Sufficient and therefore retain as it is OR · Expand (provision of additional office space)	Sufficient for now	The HQ Office and some state office facilities are sufficient. Other facilities such as
Staff remuneration and compensation	· Existing remuneration/compensation should be retained · OR · Review and standardize remuneration and compensation	Retain	It is quite competitive and may only need to regularize a few positions/persons in position

8.6 LHI Options for Growth, Development, and Sustainability

Strategic operational area(s)	Options	Consensus	Additional Opinion
Research	· Not needed and not required - OR · Needed and should be instituted	Needed and should be institutionalised	In preparation for this SP, while we were restructuring, we have factored in research into our MEL unit
Governance	· Maintain the status quo (governance responsibility in the BOT - OR · Establish the Board of Directors to stand in the gap	Maintain	We do have the Board of Directors, which we refer to as the Senior Leadership Team (SLT)
Technical input	· No need for additional technical input - OR · Constitute a Technical Advisory Committee for technical input into the operations of LHI	Constitute a programme technical team	This programme technical team may be constituted to support in the review of the programme implementation document, review SOPs or develop where there is none
Management Team	· Maintain the status quo - OR · Restructure and Expand the Management Team	Maintain	It was newly restructured as we anticipate the new Strategic Plan
Partnership and collaboration	· Maintain status quo OR · Expand and strengthen partnership and collaboration to include other private sector organisations, government (state and LGA), Faith Based Organisations etc. · Expand partnership in service delivery to PHCs and private health facilities	Expand and strengthen partnership and collaboration	For relevance, sustainability, and ensuring growth, there is a need to expand partnerships and collaborations
Programme Development	· Independent bids for new projects OR · Explore Joint bids with other organisations'	Both	Either of the options may be suitable at times
Quality Assurance	· Institutionalize Quality Improvement/Assurance practices · Establish a framework for Quality Improvement/Assurance · Build the capacity of staff in Quality Improvement/Assurance	All	We do not presently have this QI/A and all options can be adopted

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